❶ The [ApiController] attribute opts in to common conventions.

❷ The ControllerBase class provides helper functions.

❸ This would typically come from a dependency injection (DI) injected service instead.

❹ The [HttpGet] attribute defines the route template used to call the action.

❺ The name of the action method, Index, isn't used for routing. It can be anything you like.

❻ The controller exposes a single action method that returns the list of fruit.

When invoked, this endpoint returns the list of strings serialized to JSON, as shown in figure 20.2.

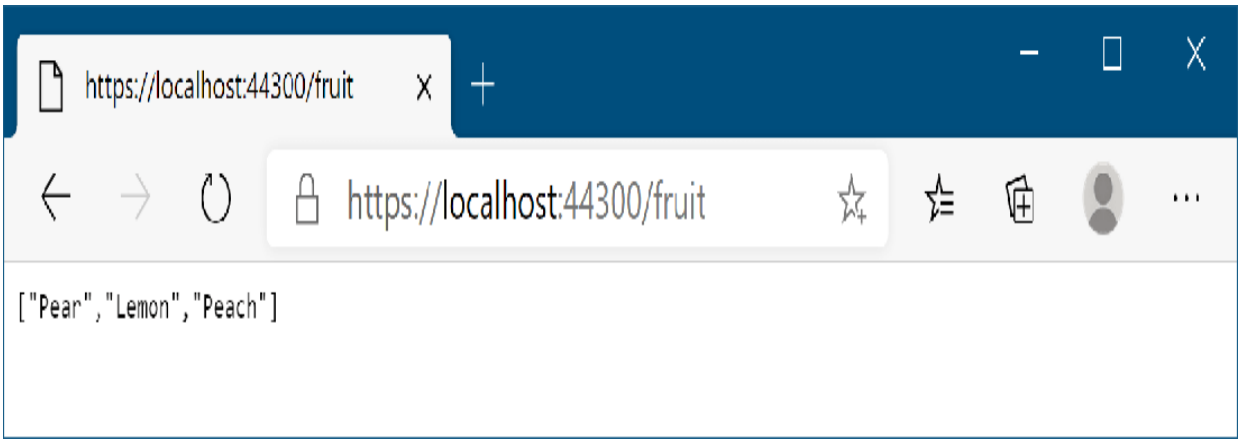


Figure 20.2 Testing the web API in listing 20.2 by accessing the URL in the browser. A `GET` request is made to the `/fruit` URL, which returns a `List<string>` that is serialized to JSON.

Web API controllers typically use the `[ApiController]` attribute (introduced in .NET Core 2.1) and derive from the `ControllerBase` class. The base class provides several helper methods for generating results, and the `[ApiController]` attribute automatically applies some common conventions, as you'll see in section 20.5.

TIP The `Controller` base class is typically used when you use MVC controllers with Razor views. You don't need to return Razor views with